The loops that decide the outcome

An arrow marked + means the two quantities move in the same direction; − means opposite. A loop with an even number of − links feeds itself (R). An odd number corrects (B).

Inside a society

Transparency
Hoarding
R1
fear feeds shortage, shortage feeds fear
Shortage, rising prices
Fear and rumor
Reserves at home
Grievance
Violence
B1
a complaint is heard and answered
Institutional response
Problems seen by institutions
Retaliation
R2
each blow brings the next

Between states

Weapons spending
R3
arms race
Threat felt by the other side
B2
talks lower the threat
Talks and inspections
Reserves at home

The dashed arrow joins the two panels: threat across a border raises fear at home.
Reserves at home appear in both panels: they absorb shortages on the left and are spent on weapons on the right.